



## Leave Policy

tech.at.core recognizes the importance of a healthy work-life balance for our t.a.cer well-being and overall productivity. This leave policy outlines the various types of leave available to our t.a.cer and provides clear guidelines for requesting and utilizing them. Our goal is to:

- Foster a culture of trust and respect by offering t.a.cer paid time off to address personal needs and responsibilities.
- Ensure fair and consistent leave administration across all departments.
- Maintain smooth operational flow by encouraging responsible leave planning and communication.

### Compensation for Unused Leave:

- **No Carryover Upon Departure:** Any unused leave balance will not be compensated upon an employee's departure from the organization.
- **No Leave Usage During Notice Period:** Employees are not permitted to utilize any remaining accrued leaves during their notice period. This ensures fairness and predictability in leave administration.
- **Carryover of Unused Leave (Limited):** Employees are permitted to carry over unused leave from the previous year into the following year, up to the end of the first quarter (March 31st).

Team members may occasionally be absent due to time off or personal reasons. tech.at.core offers various leave options, and the process for applying for each type of leave is outlined below.

### Kinds of leaves:

Subject to the Organisation / Company Policy, the following kinds of leave may be granted to an Employee:

1. Paid Leaves
  - a. Casual Leave

- b. Sick Leave
  - 2. Optional Leaves and Public Holidays
  - 3. Wedding Anniversary Leave
  - 4. Bereavement Leave
  - 5. Leave not admissible to an Employee under suspension
  - 6. Lapse of leave on cessation of service
  - 7. Accident Leave
  - 8. Adoption Leave
  - 9. New Beginnings Leave Policy [Parenthood Leave Policy]:
    - a. Full pay is admissible in case of leave of the kind mentioned in clauses (a) or (c) of sub-policy (1).
    - b. Half-pay is admissible in case of leave of the kind mentioned in clause (b) of sub-policy(1).
    - c. Full pay is admissible for the first four months and half pay for the rest of the period in case of leave of the kind mentioned in clause (d) of sub- policy (1).
  - 10. Newlywed Leave Policy
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## **Paid Leaves [18]: [Casual Leave + Sick Leave]**

### **a. Casual Leave:**

- i. Every Employee is entitled to 18 basic paid leaves in a year which is 1.5 days per month.
- ii. These leaves should be used within the year. (EX: Jan 2020 to Dec 2020).
- iii. Paid leaves that were not used within the year can be used during the first quarter of the following year if they were not used within the year.

### **b. Sick Leave:**

- i. You are ill/sick or had an accident and can not work.
- ii. Let your team or your lead and the HR Department know that you're sick and when you expect to feel better. You can post a message in your team channels in slack.



- iii. Update the HR Department and your Team Lead on how you are feeling if it takes longer than expected. Stay home until you are better.
- iv. Let your team and the HR Department know when you are back.
- v. Don't feel guilty for being sick.
- vi. Go to the doctor in time if you need to. Don't act tough.
- vii. If you have weird or vague complaints over a longer period of time like headaches, bad sleep or panic-related stuff. Check your stress level.

For instance:

John Smith has utilized 8 out of the 18 paid leaves allocated for the current year. The remaining balance of 10 leaves can be carried forward to the next year, allowing him to utilize them during the first quarter (January to March).

## Optional Leaves & Public Holidays:

At tech.at.core, we believe in providing our t.a.cers with a balanced mix of public holidays and optional holidays to accommodate diverse cultural and personal preferences. We observe a total of 10 holidays each year, which includes both public and optional holidays.

### Understanding the Holiday Structure:

We aim to provide 5 public holidays and 5 optional holidays annually. **However, the exact distribution may vary slightly depending on the calendar year.**

### Public Holidays:

Our public holiday list typically includes:

- |                   |                           |
|-------------------|---------------------------|
| 1. Republic Day   | 3. Labour Day / May Day   |
| 2. New Year's Day | 4. Independence Day       |
|                   | 5. Mahatma Gandhi Jayanti |

### Optional Holidays:

The following holidays are typically offered as optional holidays. The specific optional holidays that will be observed each year will be announced and may be chosen from the list below. The final selection will be communicated to you through your respective communication channels at the beginning of each calendar year.



- Sankranthi / Pongal
- Maha Shiva Ratri
- Ugadi
- Ramzan
- Vinayaka Chaviti
- Dasara
- Diwali

#### **Choosing Your Optional Holidays:**

- t.a.cers can freely choose your optional holidays from the list provided whenever you would like to take an optional leave. However, the standard allowance for optional holidays is 5 days per year. This number may vary slightly due to the lunar calendar and how public holidays fall each year.

*Example: For the year 2025, there are 6 optional holidays because only 4 public holidays fall on weekdays. This adjustment ensures that t.a.cers receive a total of 10 holidays.*

- *If a t.a.cer exceeds the optional leave limit (typically 5 days, but as in 2025, could be 6), any additional days taken will be considered regular paid leave (from their existing leave balance).*

#### **Important Note:**

- Due to the variations in the lunar calendar and other factors, the exact dates of some public holidays and optional leaves may change each year.
- In cases where a public holiday falls on a weekend, it will not be replaced with a pre- or post-holiday. Instead, the total number of holidays will be maintained at 10 by including that day within the optional holiday pool.
- This adjustment will be communicated to you through your respective communication channels at the beginning of each calendar year.

We strive to provide a balanced holiday calendar that respects diverse traditions and allows our t.a.cers to enjoy time off for important occasions. We will communicate the final holiday list for each year through your respective communication channels.

*If you have any questions regarding the holiday policy, please contact the HR department.*



## Wedding Anniversary Leave:

tech.at.core recognizes the importance of celebrating life's milestones. In support of a healthy work-life balance and employee well-being, we are pleased to offer a **one-day paid leave on your wedding anniversary**. This benefit allows you to spend this special occasion with your loved ones and create lasting memories.

- **Optional Leave:** *The wedding anniversary leave is completely optional.* You can **choose to take the day off** to celebrate or **continue working** on your anniversary, based on your personal preference and workload.
- **Advance Notification:** If you wish to avail of this leave must inform your Team Lead, Clients, and the HR department well in advance to ensure smooth coordination and planning.
- **Sharing Dates:** To facilitate seamless implementation, all married t.a.cers are required to share your wedding anniversary dates with HR Associate - Sranaya at the earliest.
- **Promoting Well-Being:** This policy is designed to enhance employee well-being and foster a supportive work environment.

We encourage all eligible t.a.cer to take advantage of this benefit and celebrate your wedding anniversary!

## Bereavement Leave:

tech.at.core recognizes that the loss of a loved one is a difficult and challenging experience. We offer bereavement leave to provide t.a.cers with time to grieve, make necessary arrangements, and support your families during such times.

- **Eligibility:** All t.a.cers are eligible for bereavement leave upon the death of an immediate family member, regardless of the cause of death.
- **Eligible Family Members:** This policy covers the death of the following immediate family members:
  - Partner (spouse, domestic partner)
  - Children (biological, adopted, step-, foster)
  - Parents (biological, step-, in-law)
  - Siblings



- **Leave Duration:** Eligible t.a.cers will receive 3 days of paid bereavement leave.

#### **Requesting Bereavement Leave:**

To request bereavement leave, t.a.cers should notify your Team Lead [TL] and the HR department as soon as possible. While we understand that these situations are often unexpected, prompt notification helps ensure smooth workflow and allows us to provide the necessary support.

#### **Additional Information:**

- Bereavement leave is paid and will not be deducted from the t.a.cer's regular leave balance.
- In cases of extenuating circumstances, t.a.cers may request additional unpaid leave, subject to approval from your Team Lead, Project Manager and HR.
- This policy is subject to change at the discretion of tech.at.core.

We hope that this policy provides some comfort and support to our t.a.cers during difficult times.

*Please do not hesitate to contact the HR department if you have any questions or require further assistance.*

#### **Leave not admissible to an Employee under suspension:**

Leave may not be granted to an Employee under suspension or against whom disciplinary proceedings are pending.

#### **Lapse of leave on cessation of service:**

When an Employee leaves the Company's service, any leave which remains at their credit will be forfeited. This is unless specific policies set out otherwise.

Please refer the following document to know more about

 **Policy on Payment for Leftover Leaves in Exit Formalities**

#### **Important Note:**

After submitting resignation mail, the Employee is not eligible to take any leaves. He/She needs to work under the days according to the notice period.



“We want to help our people balance life and career choices, supporting them through the joys and challenges of parenting, as they continue to focus on their careers.”

### **Accident Leave:**

Accident Leave may be granted to an Employee who sustains an injury in the course of the performance of his duties, including while on tour, for the period for which leave is certified by the Medical Officer to be necessary for recovery from the injury.

Below are the guidelines you need to follow before applying for Accident leave:

- a. An employee shall be entitled to accident leave on half pay, on production of a medical certificate, at the rate of 15 days for every calendar year of service.
- b. Additionally, an employee may be granted accident leave during the first year of his or her service at the rate of one day for every 24 days of service.
- c. Production of a medical certificate may not be insisted upon if accident leave to be granted does not exceed three days.
- d. An Employee who has availed sick leave for more than three days for reasons of health shall produce a medical certificate of fitness before he resumes duty even though such leave was not actually granted on a medical certificate.

### **Adoption Leave:**

A t.a.cer may avail Adoption Leave to nurture the child in case of adoption of a child or have a baby through a surrogate mother. The t.a.cer is eligible for 1 month paid leave.

### **New Beginnings Leave Policy [Parenthood Leave Policy]:**

#### **a. Maternity Leave:**

Being or becoming a parent can be challenging at home and at work. No matter if you are already a parent or are going to be one, you might have some questions about what tech.at.core has in place for tech.at.core moms and dads. Below is all the information you seek.

Our Maternity Leave Policy is designed to provide t.a.cer's with the necessary time and flexibility to transition into and embrace the responsibilities of parenthood.



**a. Eligibility:**

The Maternity Policy is eligible to women who have been in tech.at.core for a period at least 6 months.

**b. Required Documents:**

The t.a.cer can apply for maternity policy before 4 weeks (Which may vary in emergencies). Additionally, before applying for Maternity Leave, the employee must submit a Medical Certificate to the Team Lead, with a copy to the PM and HR Department via email.

**c. Paid Leaves:**

From the Birth of a child, leave may be applied for 6 months. In these 6 months, the t.a.cer will be receiving **basic pay** from their total income.

**d. Unpaid Leaves:**

Through the Maternity Policy, the t.a.cer can get up to 6 months unpaid leaves. At the same point she can only apply for unpaid leaves, counting from birth date of the baby to next year (means within one year).

**Baby Care - Remote Work Policy After Maternity Leave:**

t.a.cer's who have concluded their 6-month maternity leave are entitled to avail the Work From Home (WFH) Policy till your baby reaches 12 months of age. This policy allows employees to continue their professional responsibilities while providing the flexibility needed to manage parenting responsibilities.

***Baby Care Remote Work Policy Procedure:***

- t.a.cer's must submit a formal request for "Remote Work" to Team Lead, Manager and the HR Department.
- The request should include details such as the preferred start date of the WFH period and any specific considerations or arrangements needed for remote work.
- Team Lead and HR Manager will review and approve WFH requests based on business needs and individual circumstances.
  - Example: Mrs. Aayushi, a highly esteemed member of our team, has joyfully welcomed a new member to her family. As per our policy, she is entitled to work from home until her baby reaches 12 months of age. Throughout this





duration, she has the opportunity to actively contribute to the team's achievements while benefiting from the flexibility to attend to her parenting responsibilities.

### **Maternal Health and Recovery Leave Policy [Special Maternity Leave]:**

A t.a.cer is entitled up to a maximum period of 1-month **basic pay** of paid Maternal Health and Recovery Leave (Special Maternity Leave) in case of any illness arising out of pregnancy, delivery, premature birth of child, miscarriage, medical termination of pregnancy or Tubectomy operation and up to 3 months unpaid leaves. This will be approved on submission of relevant medical documents.

#### **To-do during pregnancy:**

- At least 3 months before your due date:
  - Tell your lead and HR that you are pregnant.
  - Show your pregnancy statement to HR.
- At least 3 weeks before your leave:
  - Together with your lead, set a date for your leave and inform HR.
  - Discuss possible work-related adjustments with your lead (like parental leave, breastfeeding).
- Within 4 weeks after birth:
  - Inform HR of the birth date.
  - Let your lead and HR know if you need anything when you are back at work.

Again, please let us know if you and your partner encounter unexpected complications. We'll do our best to help where we can.

**Note:** The Maternity Leave and WFH Policy are subject to the company's overall policies and procedures. Eligibility for benefits and other considerations during Maternity Leave and WFH will be in accordance with existing company policies.

We believe in fostering a supportive and inclusive work environment, and this policy is designed to assist employees in achieving a healthy work-life balance during this important phase of their lives.



## **Paternity Leave:**

Being or becoming a parent can be challenging at home and at work. No matter if you are already a parent or are going to be one, you might have some questions about what tech.at.core has in place for tech.at.core moms and dads. Below is all the information you seek.

### **a. Eligibility:**

The Paternity Policy is eligible to men who have been in tech.at.core for a period not less than 6 months or more.

### **b. Required Documents:**

Before applying for Paternity Policy the Employee should submit the Doctor Consultation Certificate to the HR Department.

### **c. Paid Leaves:**

Through Paternity Policy the Employee can have 15 days **basic pay leaves** in that year.

### **d. Unpaid Leaves:**

Through the Paternity Policy the Employee can get 1 month unpaid leaves. At the same point he can only apply for unpaid leaves, counting from birth date of the baby to next year (means within one year).

## **Newlywed Leave Policy: [Wedding Celebration Leave]**

tech.at.core recognizes the significance of marriage as a major life event. To support our t.a.cer's during this special time, we are pleased to offer Newlywed Leave Policy [Wedding Celebration Leave]. This policy provides eligible t.a.cers with paid time off to celebrate their wedding and prepare for their new life together.



#### Eligibility:

- To be eligible for the Newlywed Leave Policy [Wedding Celebration Leave], t.a.cers must be **employed full-time at tech.at.core**.

#### Leave Entitlement:

Eligible t.a.cers will be granted **five (5) paid working days** of Wedding Celebration Leave. This leave is granted once throughout the duration of their employment with tech.at.core.

#### Application and Procedure:

1. t.a.cer's must submit leave updates to the Team Lead, with CC: Project Manager and The HR Department **at least four (2) weeks prior to the intended leave date**.
2. The leave must be taken within a two (2) week window surrounding the wedding date.

#### Example:

"Mr. Ram, a full-time Software Developer, is getting married on October 20, 2024. In accordance with the Wedding Celebration Leave policy, he provided advance notification of his wedding and intended leave dates by submitting a leave request through the company's leave management system on September 20, 2024. He attached his wedding invitation to the request. He requested to take his Wedding Celebration Leave from October 18, 2024, to October 24, 2024. Upon approval, he will receive five (5) paid days off to celebrate his wedding."

#### Important Notes:

- Wedding Celebration Leave cannot be carried over or converted to cash.
- The company reserves the right to update or modify this policy at any time.

#### Our Commitment:

tech.at.core is committed to supporting our t.a.cer's in their personal and professional lives. We hope this policy helps our t.a.cers enjoy this momentous occasion.

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## Leave Application & Approval Process

To establish a clear, efficient, and equitable process for t.a.cer to request and obtain leave, while ensuring minimal disruption to business operations and maintaining accurate records of t.a.cer absences.

This Leave Application and Approval Process applies to *all* types of leave at tech.at.core, including but not limited to:

- **Casual Leave:** For personal reasons (such as personal appointments or family obligations)
- **Sick Leave:** For illness or medical appointments.
- **Optional Leaves:** For those who wish to take festival optional holidays from the provided calendar holidays list.
- **Bereavement Leave:** For who have lost their loved ones.
- **Wedding Anniversary Leave:** For those who wish to celebrate their wedding anniversary.
- **Adoption Leave:** For t.a.cer who have adopted a child.
- **Accident Leave:** For t.a.cer who have been involved in an accident.
- **Parenthood Leave (Maternity, Paternity, Maternity Health and Recovery Leave):**  
For employees who become parents or are recovering their maternal health.

To request any type of leave, please follow the process outlined below:

### 1. Submitting a Leave Request:

t.a.cers planning to take leave must obtain prior approval from your Team Lead (TL), and the HR department **at least 2 business days** before the leave start date.

### 2. Compose an email with the following details:

- Subject:** Clearly state the subject as "Leave Request - [Your Name] - [Leave Type]" (e.g., Leave Request - John Smith - Casual Leave)
- Body:**
  - Mention the type of leave you are requesting (e.g., Casual Leave, Sick Leave, Maternity Leave).



- Clearly state the start and end dates of your leave.
  - Briefly explain the reason for your leave (optional for certain leave types).
- c. Send the email to your Team Lead, with a CC to your Manager and [hr@techatcore.com](mailto:hr@techatcore.com).

### 3. Acknowledgement and Approval Process:

- a. Upon receiving your leave request, your Team Lead (TL) will respond to the same email.
  - To facilitate decision-making, HR will reply with the leave balance details before the TL provides approval or rejection.
  - If a quicker response is needed, the t.a.cer may follow up with the TL to expedite the approval process.
- b. Once your leave is approved, please inform your team a day in advance through the designated communication channel.
- c. HR will track the approved leaves accordingly.
- d. The leave approval or denial process may take **2-3 business days**. You will be notified of the decision via email.

### Respecting Leave Approval Process:

- We value the importance of both planned and unplanned personal time. Therefore, to ensure smooth operations and support our team effectively, it is essential that all leaves be approved in advance.
- **In instances where approval is not obtained, such leaves will be considered unpaid, except in cases of critical or emergency situations.**

### Leave Record Maintenance:

- Accurate records of all leave requests and approvals will be maintained by the HR department.
- t.a.cers are responsible for ensuring their leave records are accurate.



### Return to Work:

- Upon returning from leave, t.a.cers are expected to promptly inform their supervisor and team members of their return.
- They may be required to provide a brief update on any urgent matters that may have arisen during their absence.

### Policy Updates:

- This leave policy may be subject to periodic review and updates.
- Any changes to the policy will be communicated to all t.a.cers in slack .

### Important Notice:

Only **approved leaves are permitted**. Taking leave without prior approval may result in disciplinary action regarding your employment status. It is your responsibility to ensure your leave request is approved before taking any time off.

For any questions or clarifications regarding the leave policy, please contact the HR

department at [swathik@techatcore.com](mailto:swathik@techatcore.com) or

<https://techatcore.slack.com/team/U03K8C25JAC>.

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